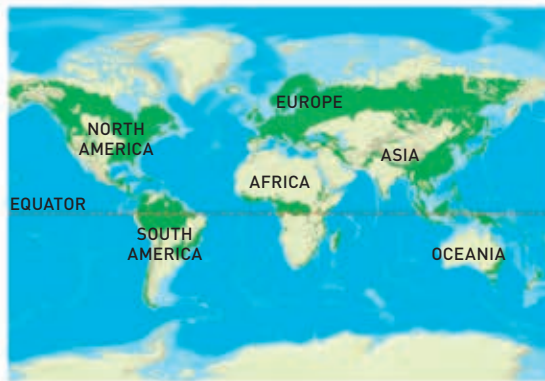


Forest

About 30 per cent of the world's land area is forest. These large areas of trees form dense canopies, which restrict the amount of light that reaches the ground. The types of trees in the forest vary with the climate, but all are home to a range of plants and animals.

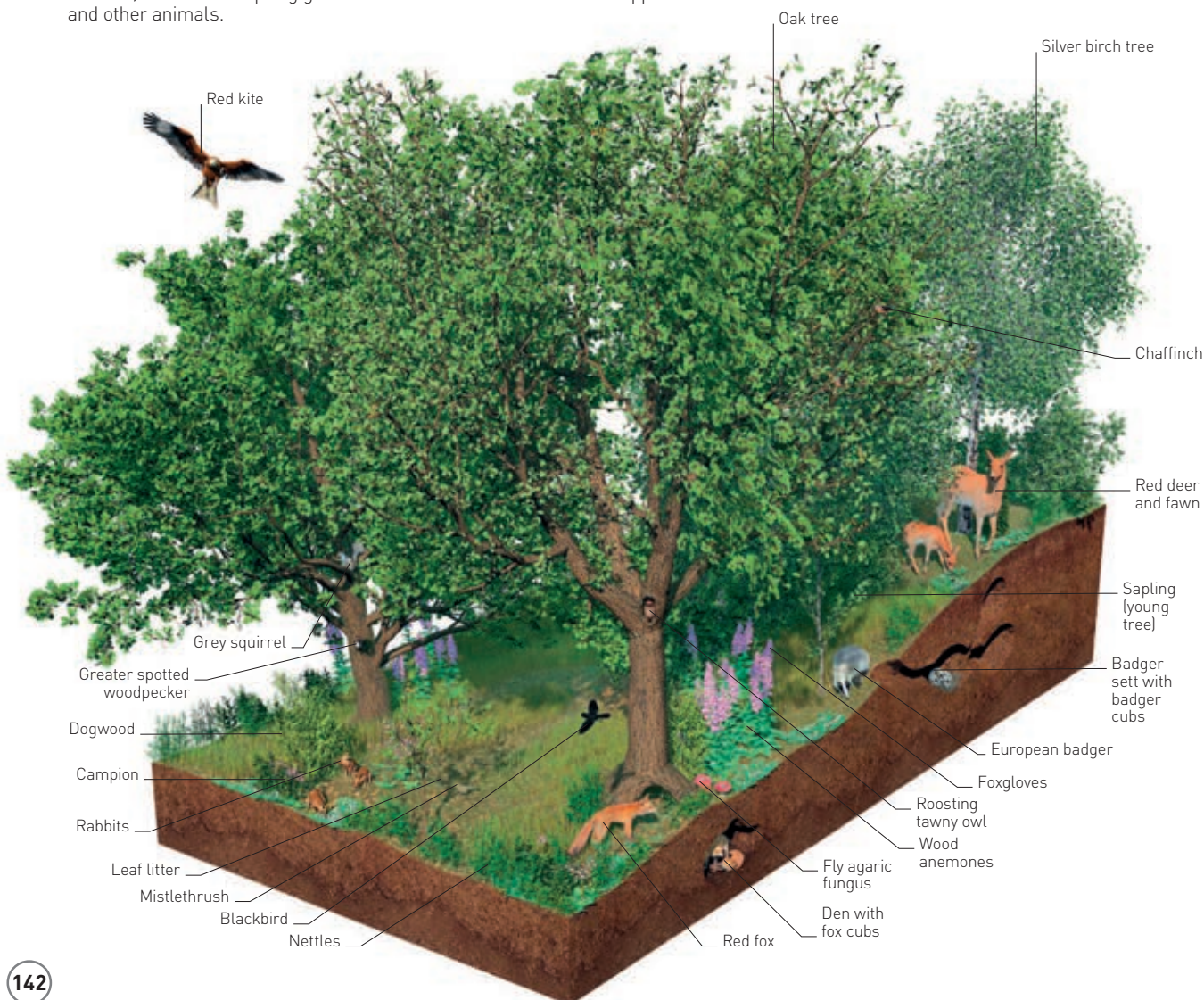
WHERE ON EARTH?

Forests grow wherever the climate is warm and rainy enough to support large numbers of trees. This allows forest of different types to grow on every continent, except Antarctica – from the hot, tropical rainforests near the equator to the cooler, snowy forests in the Arctic region.



BIODIVERSITY

Every natural forest has a variety of trees and other plants, and provides homes for many animals. In regions with cold winters and warm summers, many trees lose their leaves in winter. Animals survive by lying low or moving somewhere warmer, but the new spring growth feeds masses of insects that support birds and other animals.



TYPES OF FORESTS

Some forests contain many different species of trees, while others contain large groups of the same type. In some parts of the world, trees need special adaptations to survive cold, hot, dry, or wet seasons.



TEMPERATE DRY
These forests have hot, dry summers and mild, wet winters. Trees can be evergreen or deciduous.



TEMPERATE DECIDUOUS
A deciduous tree has large, thin leaves that make food in summer. In winter, when the weather is cold and there is little sun, deciduous trees shed their leaves.



BOREAL EVERGREEN
In cold regions, the summer is too short for deciduous trees to grow well. Here, most of the trees are conifers, with tough, needle-shaped leaves that are resistant to the cold.

MAMMALS

Many forest mammals feed on leaves, fruit, nuts, and seeds. Others, including many bats, prey on insects. Small mammals are targeted by bigger hunters such as foxes, and some forests support packs of wolves.



BIRDS

In forests with cold winters, many of the birds are summer visitors from warmer regions. They nest, raise their young, then leave. Other birds stay in the forest all year round.



PLANT LIFE

Many different types of trees grow in forests. They shelter a variety of smaller plants that can grow in shady conditions. In deciduous forests, some small plants flower in spring before they are shaded by the new leaves growing on the trees.



MOSS



ENGLISH OAK



MONTPELLIER MAPLE